

Master builders

Made from saliva, poop, and clay, termite mounds are incredible structures that can take a termite colony many years to build. The oldest termite mounds have been around since the time of the ancient Egyptians—and they are every bit as fascinating as the pyramids!

Termite mounds come in **many shapes and sizes**.

Some **birds nest** in termite mounds.

The **biggest termite mounds** are over 20 feet (6 meters) tall!

Cubitermes termites make **mushroom-shaped mounds**.

Hungry **anteaters** use their long, sticky tongues to scoop up termites from inside mounds.

Hard at work

Each termite has a different job. Male and female termite workers are responsible for building and maintaining the nest, which can be home to over one million of their brothers and sisters.

Home invasion

Many animals actually steal the incredible mounds. Ants, bees, lizards, and parrots have all lived in termite mounds!

Chimneys allow air to flow in and out of the mound, maintaining a **constant temperature**.



Chimney

Worker

